Lesson 21 - Omnipresent God

Saturday, March 28, 2026 4:14 PM

LESSON 21 – OMNIPRESENT GOD

Spiritual Principle: Children will recognize that God is in our lives, in all forms, because God is present in all beings and in all things.



Human Value: Truth
Inward Quality: Wisdom, Knowing, Faith

Prayers: (Select from the Prayers section.)
Meditation: Jyothi/light meditation or Soham meditation (Use script in Appendix.)
Spiritual Diary review: (Please review spiritual diary with children.)

(Note to gurus: Display Swami's Message or give the children a copy. Read it aloud together and then have the children read it to themselves. Give the children some time to reflect on Swami's Message. Ask them the following questions.)

Swami's Message:
"When you develop total faith in Swami's words, they will certainly come true. God's words are Divine and ambrosial. They are ever true. But if you lack faith, they may not come true. Therefore, develop firm faith. Come what may, never give up your faith under any circumstances. Faith is your life-breath."

(Sri Sathya Sai Baba, July 14, 1996)

1. What is faith?
2. How can you develop faith in God and His words?

Story:
(Note to gurus: You can ask the children the following questions before sharing the story.)

- If your friend told you that they would be coming to your home later today for a play date, would you believe them? How would you feel?
- If God told you that they would be coming to your home later today and will have lunch with you, would you believe Him? How would you feel?
- How would you decorate your house for God, if He promised to come to your house?

- If God told you that they would be coming to your home later today and will have lunch with you, would you believe Him? How would you feel?
- How would you decorate your house for God, if He promised to come to your house?
- What food would you prepare/help your family prepare for God?
- Where would you seat Him?
- How would you welcome Him?
- Does God always act in the way we expect Him to?

During the time of Shirdi Sai Avatar, there was an ardent devotee of Baba named Hemadpant. He always contemplated on Baba and kept repeating, "Baba, Baba, Baba," all the time. One day, he was awakened at night at 3 o'clock by a tall person who patted his back and said, "Hemadpant! Tomorrow I am coming to your house for food." Hemadpant wondered whether what he saw was a dream or a reality. When he noticed that the door of his house was open, he realized that this was not a dream. Then he was filled with joy and started shouting loudly, "My Baba came to me and told me that he would come to my house for food tomorrow."

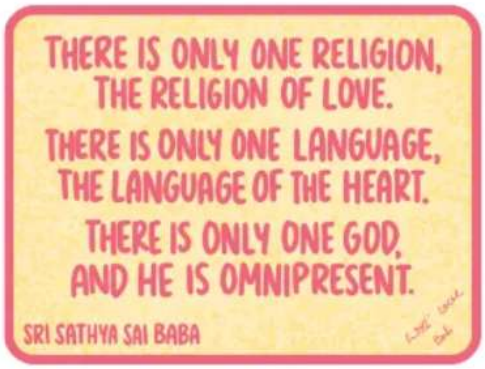
Hearing this, his wife got up and asked, "What happened to you? Did you have a dream? How is it possible for Baba to come tomorrow? Where is Shirdi and where is our house? All this is your imagination only."

(Note to gurus: You may share with the children that Hemadpant lived in Mumbai, which is about 150 miles away from Shirdi, where Baba was.)

Hemadpant said to his wife, "For God, there is nothing like far or near. How can there be any coming and going for God, who is all-pervasive? God neither comes nor goes; He is everywhere. Those who have deservedness can see Him anywhere. But those who lack deservedness cannot see Him. It all depends on one's faith."

Hemadpant told his wife, "Baba will come to our house tomorrow. Therefore, prepare befitting food tomorrow morning." She was very happy to hear that and said, "Is there any greater fortune for us than Baba visiting our house?" She got up early in the morning, cleaned the house and the cooking utensils, and prepared many delicious items such as vada (savory snack of South India), payasam (sweet pudding), etc. She decorated the house with mango leaves and garlands of flowers and waited

vada (savory snack of South India), payasam (sweet pudding), etc. She decorated the house with mango leaves and garlands of flowers and waited for the arrival of Baba.



It was 12 o'clock, but no sign of Baba's arrival was visible. She was beset with anxiety. Hemadpant tried to pacify her, saying, "Baba will never go back on his promise. Baba is the embodiment of truth. In fact, He is verily Lord Sathyanarayana. Therefore, Baba will definitely come."

It was already two o'clock, but Baba did not come. Hemadpant did not know what to do. At that very time, two people came to their house and said, "Hemadpant! You appear to be very busy. Maybe you are waiting for the arrival of some relatives. That is why you have already prepared food for them. Hence, it does not appear proper for us to disturb you at this time. We will come later. But kindly take this packet." Hemadpant took the packet, and they left.

When he opened the packet, he found Baba's picture in it. He put the picture close to his head with reverence and exclaimed, "Oh dear Baba! You have come to my house in the form of this picture!" Hemadpant placed the food before Baba's photo, closed his eyes and

prayed, "Baba! You must eat this food." When he opened his eyes, a vada was missing from the plate of food. He could also see the marks of Baba's fingers in the rice served on the plate. Then he said with joy, "Baba has eaten the food," and offered it as prasadam to all. Baba used to satisfy His devotees in this manner. Having given His word to His devotees that He would visit their house, He would come to them in some form or the other. In order to make His devotees realize that God is present in all beings, He went to their house in the form of animals also, like a buffalo, a cat, a dog, etc., and ate the food meant for Him.

When you develop total faith in Swami's words, they will certainly come true. God's words are Divine and ambrosial. They are ever true. But if you lack faith, they may not come true. Therefore, develop firm faith. Come what may, never give up your faith under any circumstances. Faith is your life-breath.

(Retold from Sri Sathya Sai Baba's Divine Discourse, July 14, 1996)

1. What was Hemadpant's dream?
2. What preparations did Hemadpant's wife make to welcome Baba to their home?
3. Did Hemadpant have faith in Baba's words?

2. What preparations did Hemadpant's wife make to welcome Baba to their home?
3. Did Hemadpant have faith in Baba's words?
4. In what form did Baba come to Hemadpant's house?

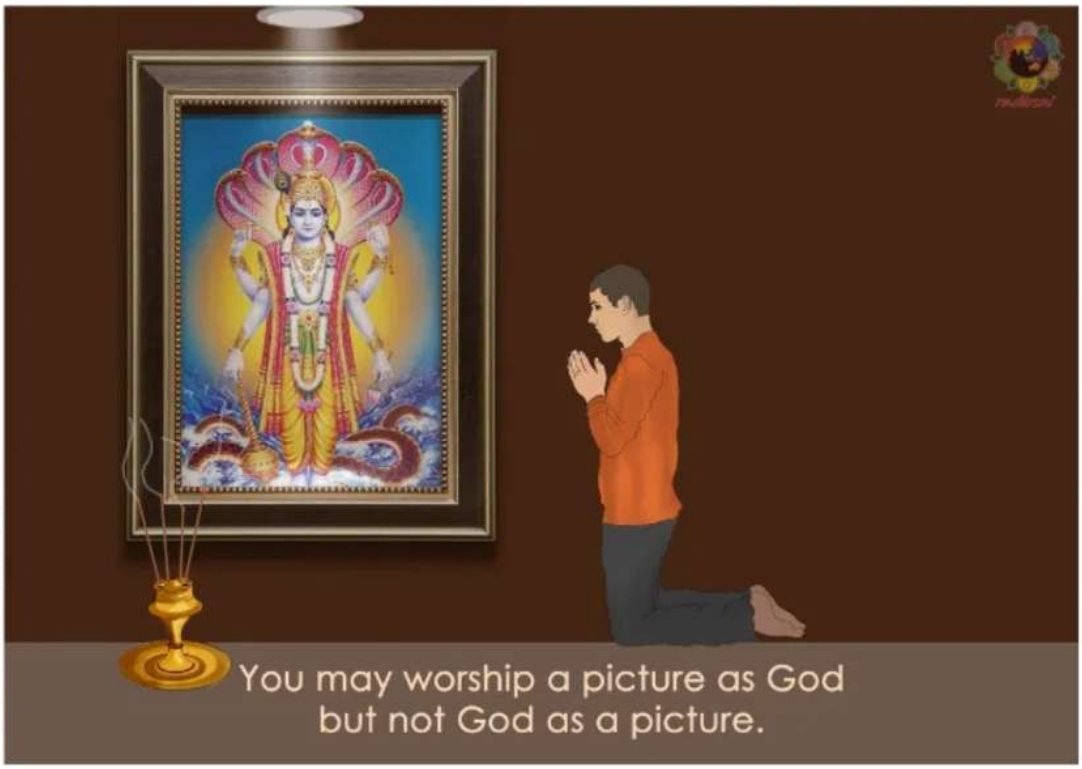


Image courtesy of SSSMC/RadioSai

Group Activity:
The children can draw and color in the scenario of God visiting their home. You may use the following prompts to help them think about this.

- Think of your favorite God. (If some children are not able to do that, ask them to think of their favorite person.)
- If they told you that they will be visiting you at your home soon, what are all the things you would do to prepare for their visit?
- Would you make your bed? Would you put your things away from the living room? What are some other things you would do?
- Would you decorate your home in a special way, like you may be doing during

- Would you make your bed? Would you put your things away from the living room? What are some other things you would do?
- Would you decorate your home in a special way, like you may be doing during festivals?
- Would you ask your mother to cook something special? What would it be? Would you help your parents in the kitchen?

(Note to gurus: You can also have this as a discussion in class where the children think about the prompts above and share. Another option would be to write about this. You may also change the prompts above and have the scenario of God visiting the class.)

(Note to gurus: The activity in Lesson 23 will require some time to prepare. Give children two weeks lead time and assign it now.)

Activity Prep for Lesson 23: Children will create a presentation (either on a sheet of posterboard, or on a slideshow) about themselves and their families. This can include where their parents are from, where they are from, information about themselves, and special traditions that their family participates in. Encourage children to use family photographs, audio, and video. You can even give them a slideshow blank deck with headers to help them get started.

Spiritual Diary: (Use template from Appendix. Give reminders & motivate children.)
Bhajans: (Select from the Bhajan section)
Prayers: (Select from the Prayers section)



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